Application: 0000000492

- ivan@ambientsystems.ai
Endless Frontier Labs Application

Summary

ID: 0000000492

Endless Frontier Labs Application 2023

Completed - Jul 27 2023

Application Form

Section 0. CEO Equalivalant/Primary Contact

CEO Equivalent/Primary Contact Information

First Name

Ivan

Last Name

Damnjanovic

Email

ivan@ambientsystems.ai

Contact Phone Number

Country Code	USA (+1)
Phone Number	[redacted]

Where is your company physically headquartered?

Country	Singapore
City	Singapore
State/Province	Singapore

Section 1. Company Information

Company Information

Tell us about your company.

Company Name

NOTE: Do not include Inc., LLC, GmbH, etc. This is how your company will be registered in our records.

Ambient Systems

Describe what your company does in 100 words or less:

Be concise, and consider the following template: "(Company) looks to (the value you deliver) by (what you do) using (your product or technology)".

Example: "TestCo improves family health by removing airborne viruses and bacteria in the household using a patented UV light device."

Ambient Systems uses AI to help businesses improve financial performance. We focus on providing a comprehensive yet easy-to-use interface, ability to track and manage large amounts of data, and ability to comply with complex regulations, such as net zero.

What is your company's long-term vision and why is it important to you as a founder?

Our vision is to bridge the gap between financial performance and climate change (net zero/decarbonization) using technology like AI. This is important to me as a founder because finance and technology are two key drivers of positive socio-economic development in the world. Working in Canada and emerging markets in Asia, I've noticed similar challenges faced by businesses of different sizes. I've set out to solve this challenge by pursuing a master's degree in computer science, bridging software innovation with real world experience from the consulting world and energy technology startups that I've worked on previously.

What track best fits your company?

Endless Frontier Labs operates three tracks:

- - for startups developing cutting edge solutions with applications such as robotics, hardware, new materials, quantum computing, advanced manufacturing, renewable energy, climate tech, Internet of Things, sensors, AR/VR, and more.
- **Digital Tech** - for startups with novel software, AI/ML, or digital services with applications in finance, health, security, supply chains, Enterprise SaaS, education, retail, media, e-commerce, and related verticals.
- **Life Sciences** - for startups tackling complex problems in biology, chemistry or related fields with applications in therapeutics, drug discovery, drug design, delivery, diagnostics, and other human or animal health-focused verticals.

If you are unsure, please pick the best fit, and EFL will make final assignments if admitted.

Have you incorporated or formed any legal entity?

Yes

Please specify (e.g. Inc., LLC, GmbH, etc.)

Ambient Systems Pte. Ltd. (Singapore)

When was your company founded?

Enter a year in YYYY format

2021

Number of full-time employees:

Enter digits only

1

Does your company have a website?

Yes

Company Website

Please enter your full URL, including "https://"

https://www.ambientsystems.ai/

Do you have a ?

Yes

Upload your :

Ambient Systems Pitchdeck.pdf

Filename: Ambient Systems Pitchdeck.pdf **Size:** 6.3 MB

Section 2. Market Information

Market Information

Tell us about the market need you are trying to address.

Describe the customer pain point you are trying to solve. Why was it not solved earlier?

We're solving a series of challenges in financial operations. These pain points are ensuring financial data is compliant and comprehensive, finance teams are siloed from revenue-generating teams, conventional reporting is backward-looking, balancing short-term and long-term goals, managing and analyzing large volumes of data, and keeping up with latest financial trends. The reason that this hasn't been solved is because the current solutions are too standardized and too manual. This makes them less impactful for getting the last-mile improvements in big businesses and too complex to get any benefit if you're a smaller company. Part of this issue has been lack of alternatives in the technology space.

What best describes your business model?

B2B

Who are your current or potential competitors?

We have mostly large enterprise software products as the competitive alternatives.

Here are some of the tools that companies can use to improve their financial performance:
https://www.gong.io/
https://www.oracle.com/financial-services/
https://www.microsoft.com/en-sg/microsoft-365/access
https://www.outreach.io/
https://www.algo.com/platform/
https://www.charthop.com/
https://www.onestream.com/
https://www.cubesoftware.com/

Does your product / service require regulatory approval for commercialization in your target markets?

No

Section 3. Product Information

Product Information

Tell us about your product or service.

Describe your company's product or service and what it does or will do:

We focus on analysis of data in niche set of industries where revenues and increased personnel utilization are positively correlated. These are often in asset heavy industries that are constrained by the amount of capital they can raise. We help commercial real estate companies maximize their revenues by helping them get more out of their existing assets while increasing the utilization of their workforce without additional manual effort or replacing any workflows. Ambient Systems has demonstrated this in a niche commercial real estate property business in Singapore. We're excited to demonstrate this technology with similar companies in North America.

Describe any sources of differentiation and competitive advantage in your product. Please highlight how your technology is novel, differentiated and / or transformational.

Ambient has three main differentiations and competitive advantages. It's really simple: simplifies the user journey from goals to benefits. It's really fast: uses AI to increase speed to results. It's really accurate: very flexible and customizable with dedicated service & support. This is transformational because the current market is fragmented and requires extensive manual effort. Our differentiation comes from the customization of the dataset selection and acquisition. For example, certain industries we target can leverage IoT datasets to supplement their financial operations. We pair these datasets with reporting templates as well as AI models to speed up the process.

How have you tested or validated your scientific or technological innovation?

We've demonstrated the use of technology at a vertical farm in Singapore. We've also developed a functional prototype and demonstrated it at a Google for which we've received a 1st runner-up spot in Singapore. Since then, we've been collaborating with multiple partners on further pilot studies to validate additional use cases.

How far along is your product?

Tell us the stage of your product, service, or technology. Include any work you have done to validate that it works as intended.

We've won 1st runner-up spot in a Singapore Google . We've also received a patent in 30+ states in two languages: English and French. We're currently developing a new use case through an ongoing R&D collaboration with a multi-national Fortune 500 global firm. We're in the process of validating how the technology can be tied with a company's financial management process. This requires further validation and testing of the real time database integration.

What is the biggest obstacle that could prevent your product from being successful in the next 6 months?

It's not easy to find early adopters. We have validated the problem, pain points, and the opportunity, but the audience we interviewed may not be the best fit for early adopters. Finding early adopters can feel like searching for a needle in the haystack.

We have a potential market of several thousand customers in one of the target customer segments in Singapore alone. This is beyond the amount of contacts that a founder or a co-founding team can validate.

Without sufficient investment from the customer side, it is difficult to realize the benefits of a transformation project. However, the benefits could be immense not just for the individual customers (accounts), but the industry as a whole.

Who owns the technology?

Us

How do you plan to protect your technology (e.g., patents, trade-secrecy, etc.)? For any current and pending IP protection, please complete the question below

We have built the entire application and own the channel for distribution with the user.

We have an exclusive license for the patent in one of the industries where we did the pilot.

We are evaluating further IP opportunities with a multinational.

Do you have any assigned or pending patents?

Yes

For each patent, please enter your:

- Patent or application numbers

- Listing patent authority

- Application status

1	WO - Granted
2	(No response)
3	(No response)
4	(No response)
5	(No response)

Section 4. Traction and Progress

Traction & Progress

Tell us about your company's progress and accomplishments.

List any of your company's accomplishments to-date. Include any proof of traction or commercial progress.

Examples: Number of early users, pilots, partnerships, awards, media and press releases

Awards and recognition for inventiveness.

- First Runner-up in Google in Singapore
- Proof of Concept (POC) Pilot in Singapore
- Patent License

Early Users/Feedback:

- 5 REITs with AUM over $1B in the Pipeline
- Singapore public sector technology offer posting
- Collaborating with a global 500 Fortune company on R&D

Media/Press:

- Google Cloud Official
- University of Toronto article about Ivan Damnjanovic

Do you have customers?

No

Do you have revenue?

Answer yes if someone has paid you for your product or service

No

How do you plan to generate first revenue? Describe any future milestones.

We need some advice whether to go down the professional services path (i.e., consulting or custom software development) or bootstrap the validation process for the broader opportunity. So far, we've gone the second route but it has not converted to revenues as we've been either been stuck validating a problem in a market too small for VCs (e.g., vertical farming/Agri-Tech) or not having a complete solution for a much bigger opportunity (e.g., financial planning and management software market).

What is the size of your target market (TAM, SAM, SOM)?

SOM: Financial Planning Software Market: (CAGR: 16.6% until 2031)
SAM: Financial Management Software Market: (CAGR: 9% until 2026)
TAM: Global Financial Services Market: (CAGR: 7.5% until 2027)

Section 5. Team Information

Team Information

Tell us about your founding team.

How many C-level founders does your company have?

1

Please pick the option that best describes your founding team.

First startup for all founders

Why do you think your team, including your advisors, is best qualified to succeed in your current business?

Please consider the unique skill sets each person brings, such as business acumen, domain knowledge, and operational experience.

Ivan has worked on sustainability projects in Asia and North America since 2013. He brings a wealth of experience at the forefront of startups. He has a master's degree in computer science from #1 ranked University in Asia and #8 ranked university in the world (National University of Singapore). He's led business development for a Y-Combinator backed startup in the past while growing the early team from 3 to over 20 employees in less than 18 months.

Founder Information (Please repeat for each founder)

First Name:	Ivan
Last Name:	Damnjanovic
Title	CEO and Founder
Email:	ivan@ambientsystems.ai
Time commitment:	Full-Time
	Man
Current or highest education:	MS
Field of study:	Computer Science
Awarding institution:	National University of Singapore
LinkedIn	

List any expert advisors (e.g. technical, scientific, business, regulatory, etc.) and the specific expertise they bring to your team. Please include LinkedIn, if applicable.

If none, put "N/A."

We've had numerous advisors in the past several years.
We're not currently engaging expert advisors.

Section 6. Funding Information

Funding Information

Tell us about your past funding and how much capital you are currently raising.

Unless otherwise stated, enter amounts in US Dollars. Convert to US Dollar equivalent amount if using another currency.

Please specify your current investment stage.

Pre-seed

Have you raised money from outside investors?

Yes

How much money have you raised from investors to date? Do not include grants or awards.

Investors can be angels, VC's, and family offices. Enter your amount in US Dollars. Convert to US Dollar equivalent amount if using another currency.

$ 107,000

Provide information on the last round closed

Total raised:	107,000
Date closed:	12/12/2022
Type of round:	Pre-seed
Type of investor:	Other
List any investors you may want to include in the application	N/A
What type of Legal instruments were used to raise?	
of Investor - Other:	University, Angel, and Friends and Family

Are you currently fundraising?

Yes

Provide information on your current open round

How much funding are you seeking/raising right now?	450,000
How much is currently committed:	0
Type of round:	Seed
List any investors you may want to include with this application	We've spoken with several leading investors in Singapore but we have to circle back after making some more progress on the commercial side.
What is your current monthly burn rate? (enter as $US)	10,000
How many months of runway does your company have left?	2
Has your company ever received non-equity grants or awards?	Yes
Awarding institution:	Other
Total non-equity grants or awards:	$4,511
Awarding Institution - Other:	Action Community for Entrepreneurship (Singapore)

Section 7. Concluding Section

Concluding Section

A few last questions for our application review team.

Have you applied to EFL previously?

No

Is anyone in your startup or advisory team affiliated with NYU?

No

Select the specific functions you hope to receive the most assistance with during EFL:

Responses Selected:

Fundraising

Other: SaaS vs Services (consulting)

What is your main objective for joining the EFL program?

We need a good partner for North America. Ivan's worked in Singapore since launching Ambient Systems. We see more opportunity in North America and feel NYU would be a good partner for us. EFL's interest in also aligns with our own value of using technology for socioeconomic progress.

Have you been affiliated with another startup program, accelerator, or incubator, either now or in the past?

Yes

Please Specify:

National University of Singapore: Graduate Research and Innovation Programme
Singapore Management University: Business Innovations Generator

How did you hear of EFL?

Responses Selected:

Email

Please specify your answer above.

For example, if you attended a conference, include the name of the conference; if you were referred to apply, please specify the name of the individual(s) who referred you, etc.

National University of Singapore GRIP forwarded invitation for startups to apply.

Tell us a fun fact about your team that is not related to your company.

Ivan is currently learning Korean and French.
He believes AI thinks differently in different languages.

Is there anything else you want to share with us?

Not at this time.

We strongly advise applicants to submit a product video or demo, if available, along with their application. This step is available after marking this form complete below.

Improving Financial Performance is Often a Complex Challenge

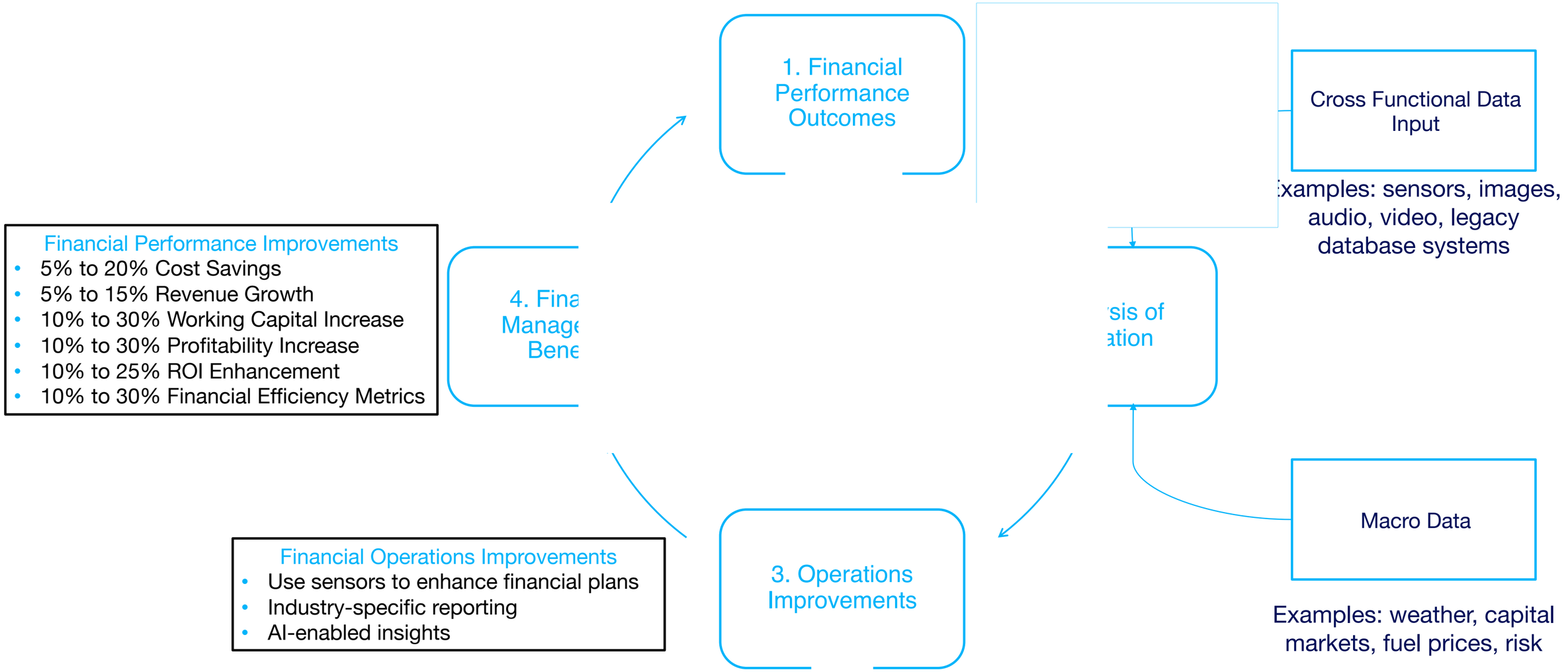
Financial Planning	• Forecast future budget • Make long-term investments • Manage cash flow
Reporting	• New compliance requirements for decarbonization • Traditional accounting is time-consuming, error prone, and difficult to track • Pay/Manage Taxes
Insights	• Require multiple data sources and large volumes of data (hard to group) • Cost-control • Manage risks

Financial experts agree that financial performance and financial operations improvements are positively correlated.

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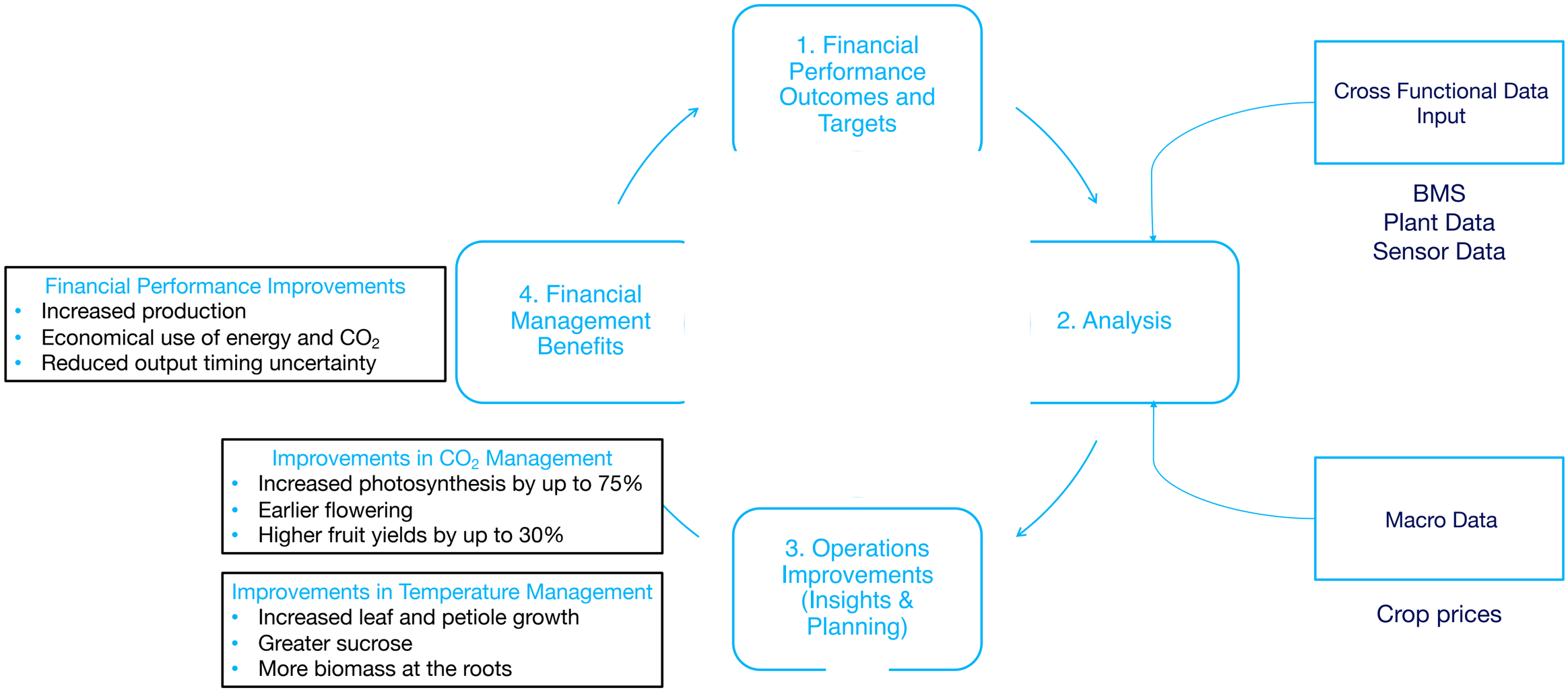


We Propose an Industry-Specific Financial Management Software Powered by AI



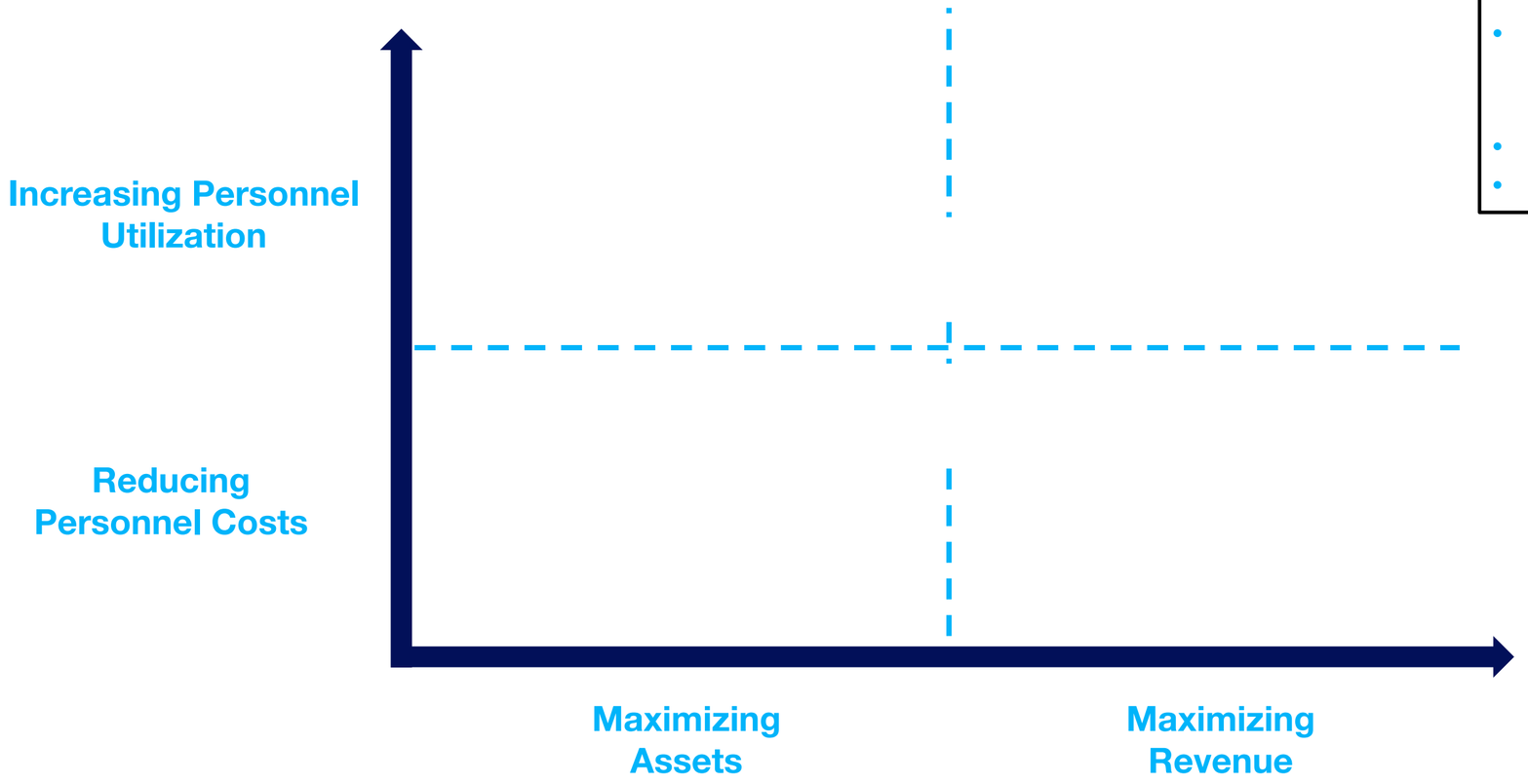
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Case Study of Improving Revenues for a Specialized Commercial Real Estate Property (Vertical Farm)



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There are Many Advantages to Using Ambient Systems for Financial Management over Conventional Software



Ambient Systems

- Focused on increasing personnel utilization while maximizing revenues from existing assets
- Industry-specific capabilities
- Easy to deploy, use, and scale

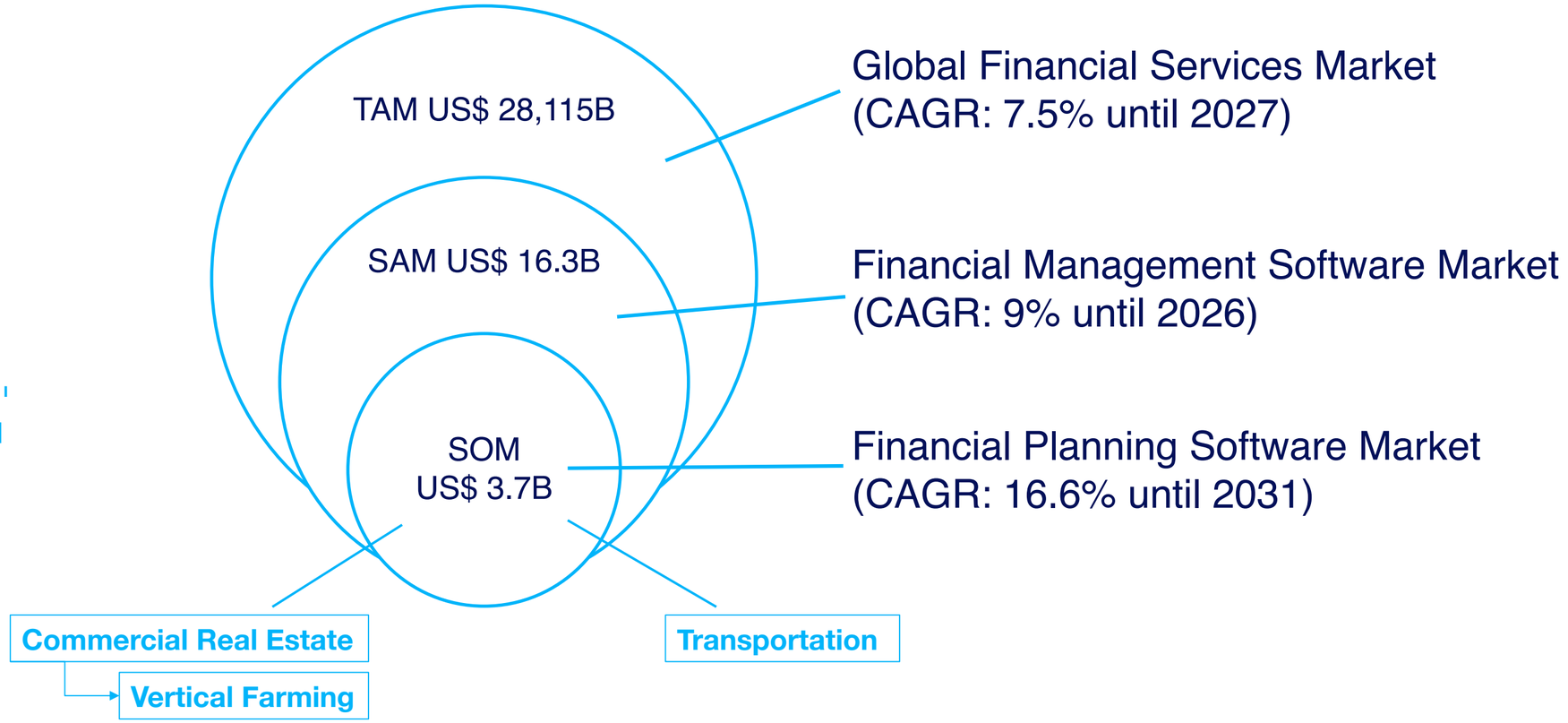
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We Have a Software Subscription Model With Three Plans And Pay-as-you-go Model For Additional Cloud Computing

Feature	Basic	Standard	Premium	Pay-as-You-Go Computing Costs
Budgeting and Forecasting	✓	✓	✓	-
Financial Reporting	✓	✓	✓	-
Community Forum Access	✓	✓	✓	-
Industry Specific Reporting	×	✓	✓	-
Dedicated Customer Support	×	✓	✓	-
File Import	×	Up to 1 GB		Based on Needs
Platform & Database Integrations	×	Up to 3 Connections		Based on Needs
Dataset Verification	×	Up to 3 Checks		Based on Needs
Compliance Reports	×	Sold separately	Sold separately	-
Financial Experts	×	Sold separately	Sold separately	-
Workflow Automation	×	×	1 included	
	×	×	1 included	-
Tentative Price (Subject to change)	Free	$499/month $5,988/year	$5,000/month $60,000/year	

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We Have an Advantage by Starting with Niche Markets and



Source: Allied Market Research, Gartner, The Business Research Company

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Experienced Leadership With Support from the Technology Industry and the Academia

Partners:



- 8 ye as a Founder) with technology startups in Asia and North America.
- Previously interned at Deloitte Canada.
- Master's Degree in Computer Science from NUS (1st ranked in Asia and 8th ranked in the world).
- Bachelor's Degree in Civil Engineering from U of T (1st ranked in Canada).

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Join us in catalyzing the financial transformation of smart industries

https://bit.ly/m/ambient-systems

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